September 14, 2026

Prof. Michael Carolan
Editor
British Food Journal

Re: Manuscript BFJ-07-2026-1291

Dear Professor,

Thank you for your message regarding the second-round evaluation of our manuscript entitled “The Emerging Research Frontier of Food Analytics: Artificial Intelligence, Consumer Analytics, Smart Food Systems, and Knowledge-Driven Intelligence”. We appreciate the opportunity to further revise the manuscript in response to the reviewer’s comments and the editorial guidance provided by the *British Food Journal*.

We are grateful for the reviewer’s careful assessment of the revised manuscript and for recognizing the potential contribution of its descriptor-level emergence analysis and integrated bibliometric tech-mining approach. We have carefully considered each comment raised in this second round of review and have further revised the manuscript to strengthen the articulation of its contribution, methodological transparency, analytical interpretation, and implications.

In the following table, we provide a structured, point-by-point response to all comments received in this **second round**. For each comment, we explain how we addressed it and identify the corresponding revisions in the manuscript. We have clearly indicated all modifications in the tracked-changes version submitted alongside the revised manuscript.

Methodological clarification. As established in the first revision, this study is a technological-intelligence investigation conducted through bibliometric tech-mining methods, rather than a conventional systematic or bibliometric literature review. Its analytical workflow constructs and normalizes descriptors from bibliographic and textual information, identifies temporal emergence at the descriptor level, and subsequently analyzes the co-occurrence structure of the resulting emergent research frontier. This distinction is important because several recommendations in this second review originate from conventional bibliometric-review practices. We adopted those recommendations where they improve transparency, reproducibility, or interpretation; where a recommendation does not align with the study's analytical design, we explain the methodological rationale and the procedures actually employed.

Table 1.

Comments from the review report.

Commentary	Answer to Reviewers
Originality and advancement over previous reviews. Clarify how the proposed approach advances previous bibliometric and technology-focused reviews of AI, big data analytics, smart food systems, food supply chains, personalized nutrition, and digital transformation in the food sector.	The first revision already strengthened the comparison with previous Food Analytics-related reviews through Section 2.3 and the comparative review table, distinguishing the present study from prior bibliometric and technology-focused analyses of individual technologies, applications, and thematic structures. The current Section 2.4 also explains the methodological advancement provided by descriptor enrichment and normalization followed by descriptor-level emergence detection before co-word network construction and community detection. Following the present comment, we identified one aspect that could be made more explicit: the advancement in analytical scope relative to previous reviews of AI, big data analytics, smart food systems, food supply chains, personalized nutrition, and digital transformation. Section 2.4 has therefore been clarified to state that these areas have largely been examined as distinct technological or application streams, whereas the present study investigates their convergence within a common Food Analytics domain and identifies the emerging structure connecting them. This clarification makes explicit that the advancement over previous reviews is twofold: integrative in scope, by examining the convergence of previously fragmented research streams, and methodological in analytical sequence, by

	constructing and normalizing an enriched descriptor space and identifying emergence before co-word network and community analysis. The resulting four higher-order dimensions therefore synthesize the developing structure of Food Analytics rather than reproducing a thematic map of any single technology or application area.
Nature of the contribution. Clarify whether the contribution is primarily methodological (emergence-detection framework), conceptual (Food Analytics research framework), empirical (identification of emerging themes/research trajectories), or a combination of these contributions.	The first revision strengthened the methodological and conceptual positioning of the study, particularly in Section 2.4, by distinguishing the present analysis from previous reviews and explaining that emergence is evaluated at the descriptor level before co-word clustering. Following the present comment, we recognized that the relationship among the methodological, conceptual, and empirical contributions could be stated more explicitly. Section 2.4 has therefore been revised to clarify that the study makes an integrated methodological and conceptual contribution, supported by empirical findings. The methodological contribution lies in the analytical architecture that combines descriptor enrichment and normalization with descriptor-level emergence detection before co-word network construction and community detection, thereby mapping the thematic structure specifically among emergent rather than established research topics. The conceptual contribution is the resulting integrative representation of the developing structure of Food Analytics through four interacting higher-order dimensions. Empirically, the 111 emergent descriptors and five Louvain communities identify the emerging thematic structure from which this conceptual synthesis is derived. This revision makes the nature and relationship of the study's contributions explicit.
Theoretical value of descriptor-level emergence. Strengthen the theoretical positioning and explain why identifying emerging descriptors provides knowledge beyond conventional bibliometric trend mapping and existing technology-focused reviews.	The first revision established the operational distinction between conventional bibliometric mapping and the present descriptor-level emergence analysis by explaining that emergence is evaluated before co-word network construction and community detection. It also clarified that emergence should not be equated with a concept appearing for the first time: an emergent signal may reflect recent acceleration, recombination, or convergence of previously existing research streams. However, following the present comment, we recognized that the theoretical value of this distinction could be stated more explicitly. Section 2.4 has therefore been strengthened to explain the different knowledge produced by descriptor-level emergence analysis. Conventional bibliometric indicators based on frequency, citation, or co-occurrence primarily characterize the prominence and structure of topics represented in a literature. In contrast, the emergence procedure evaluates whether normalized concepts exhibit a temporally distinctive combination of novelty, persistence, and recent growth. This makes it possible to identify rapidly developing research signals that may still be comparatively small relative to mature, highly visible topics and to detect acceleration, recombination, and convergence before these developments necessarily dominate the broader thematic structure. The theoretical value of the approach therefore lies in shifting the analytical question from what currently structures the literature to what is currently undergoing a meaningful process of emergence within that structure. Because the subsequent co-word network is constructed only from descriptors satisfying the emergence criteria, the resulting communities characterize relationships within the emerging research frontier rather than the overall established knowledge structure. This distinction has now been made explicit in Section 2.4.
Critical synthesis with previous literature. Deepen the literature review and Discussion by systematically comparing the findings with previous bibliometric and systematic reviews, identifying similarities, differences, and theoretical extensions.	The first revision substantially strengthened the comparison with previous literature by expanding Sections 2.2–2.4 and adding Table 1, which compares prior reviews by scope, database, period, bibliometric technique, approach to emergence, and unresolved gap. That revision established the distinction between previous technology- or application-specific mappings and the present descriptor-level emergence analysis. Following the present comment, we recognized that the manuscript could go further by connecting those prior reviews directly to the empirical findings. We have therefore strengthened both the literature review and the Discussion. Section 2.3 now makes explicit that previous reviews provide the comparative baseline for determining whether the dimensions identified in this study

	reproduce established trajectories, reveal changes within them, or extend them through convergence. Section 5 has also been expanded to compare the four dimensions systematically with previous review findings. The comparison shows substantial continuity in three areas: intelligent food quality and composition analytics extends earlier work on AI-enabled processing and quality assessment; predictive and operational food-system analytics builds on previous research concerning supply chains, traceability, sustainability, and smart food systems; and personalized nutrition and consumer analytics extends established work on recommendation, dietary assessment, and consumer behavior. The principal difference is that these streams emerge here as structurally interconnected components of a common Food Analytics domain rather than as separate technological or application areas. The semantic, generative, and knowledge-driven dimension provides the clearest extension by connecting knowledge representation, generative AI, and semantic infrastructures across the other substantive dimensions. The revised Discussion therefore distinguishes continuity from extension without treating emergence as synonymous with complete novelty. The theoretical extension lies in interpreting Food Analytics as an increasingly integrated analytical domain organized around the interaction of measurement, prediction, personalization, and knowledge representation, rather than as a collection of independent digital technologies and applications.
Positioning of the four dimensions. Explain how the four identified dimensions confirm, extend, or challenge previous conceptualizations of Food Analytics, AI-driven food systems, and digital transformation in the food sector, and relate them to broader perspectives in information systems, food science, and technology innovation.	The first revision already clarified that the four dimensions are a higher-order interpretive synthesis derived from five empirical Louvain communities and that the predominantly methodological community operates across the substantive dimensions rather than constituting an independent application domain. The manuscript also positioned Food Analytics as a developing socio-technical field integrating food science, data science, operations management, nutrition, and information systems. Following the present comment, however, we recognized that the theoretical relationship between the four dimensions and these broader disciplinary perspectives required more explicit development. Section 5 has therefore been expanded to explain how the four dimensions confirm, extend, and challenge previous conceptualizations. They confirm several trajectories already documented in the literature, including analytical food-quality assessment, supply-chain and operational intelligence, personalized nutrition and consumer analytics, and digital food technologies. They extend these perspectives by showing that these streams form an interconnected analytical architecture rather than remaining independent application areas. At the same time, the findings challenge a purely technology-centric interpretation of Food Analytics as the application of AI or other digital technologies to food-related problems. The revised discussion now relates the dimensions explicitly to broader disciplinary perspectives. Intelligent food quality and composition analytics connects Food Analytics to the measurement, characterization, and domain knowledge of food science. Predictive and operational analytics and semantic/knowledge-driven analytics connect it to information-systems concerns with data integration, interoperability, information flows, knowledge infrastructures, and decision support. Personalized nutrition and consumer analytics introduces the human-centered decision layer through which analytical outputs are adapted to individual characteristics and contexts. From a technology-innovation perspective, the dimensions indicate increasing recombination of sensing, AI, operational, consumer, and semantic technologies rather than isolated adoption of individual tools. On this basis, the revised manuscript conceptualizes Food Analytics as an emerging interdisciplinary socio-technical field in which food-science knowledge, information infrastructures, analytical intelligence, and decision processes converge. We deliberately avoid interpreting the four dimensions as a deterministic chronological sequence, because the present analysis demonstrates their contemporary emergence and interdependence rather than a longitudinal progression from one dimension to another.
Scopus as the sole database. Provide a clearer rationale for selecting Scopus as the only bibliographic database.	The rationale for using Scopus as the sole bibliographic database was substantially expanded during the first revision in Section 3.1.1. That revision established its multidisciplinary coverage across the disciplinary areas constituting Food Analytics, supported the choice with the independent

	database-comparison study of Mongeon and Paul-Hus (2016), explained the methodological advantages of maintaining a single internally consistent metadata source for descriptor-level analysis, discussed the additional harmonization required to combine Scopus with Web of Science or OpenAlex, and explicitly acknowledged the associated coverage limitation. Following the present comment, we revisited this rationale and identified one aspect that could be stated more explicitly: the relationship between database coverage and the analytical objective of the study. Section 3.1.1 has therefore been further clarified to explain that Scopus's multidisciplinary breadth is particularly appropriate because the study seeks to identify emerging relationships across food science, agriculture, nutrition, engineering, computer science, business, and management rather than characterize a single specialized literature. The rationale for retaining a single database remains methodological. The analysis operates on an internally consistent Scopus corpus and uses normalized descriptors as the analytical units for emergence detection and subsequent co-occurrence analysis. Combining heterogeneous bibliographic databases would require record deduplication, field harmonization, and reconciliation of indexing, keyword, descriptor, and metadata structures before these analytical stages, potentially introducing additional inconsistencies into the descriptor space itself. We therefore retain Scopus as the sole source while explicitly recognizing in Section 6 that this choice may omit relevant publications indexed exclusively elsewhere.
Conceptual delimitation of Food Analytics. Strengthen the conceptual basis used to define Food Analytics as a research domain.	The conceptual delimitation of Food Analytics has been strengthened in the Introduction. The manuscript already characterized Food Analytics as a developing interdisciplinary field whose distinctive feature is not any particular technology, but the integration of heterogeneous food-related data with computational, instrumental, and data-intensive approaches. In response to the reviewer's comment, we have made the boundary of this domain more explicit. The revised text now specifies that Food Analytics is conceptually delimited by the substantive integration of food-related data or evidence with analytical or computational methods to generate knowledge or decision support specific to food-system problems. It also clarifies the corresponding exclusion boundary: studies in which food is merely contextual, or in which analytical techniques do not make a substantive contribution to understanding or decision-making within food systems, are not considered part of the domain. This clarification strengthens the conceptual definition while maintaining consistency with the inclusion and exclusion criteria subsequently used to operationalize Food Analytics during corpus construction.
Descriptor normalization and thesaurus construction. Explain more transparently the criteria, development, and validation procedures used for descriptor normalization and thesaurus construction.	Descriptor normalization and thesaurus construction were substantially expanded during the first revision in Section 3.3. The current description distinguishes the automatic and manual stages of normalization; specifies the lexical variants addressed by deterministic rules; explains the use of fuzzy matching and stem variations for candidate identification; clarifies that stemming or lemmatization was not used as a general normalization procedure; describes manual validation of candidate mappings, acronyms, and conceptual synonyms; provides representative normalization examples; and explains the iterative refinement of the thesaurus during descriptor and cluster inspection. Following the present comment, we re-examined this description and identified one criterion that could be stated more explicitly. Section 3.3 has therefore been further clarified to distinguish candidate identification from conceptual validation. Lexical similarity is now explicitly described as a mechanism for generating candidate relationships rather than as evidence sufficient for automatic consolidation. Candidate mappings were incorporated into the thesaurus only after manual validation established conceptual equivalence in the bibliographic context, while lexically similar descriptors representing distinct concepts were retained separately. This clarification makes the decision criterion underlying thesaurus construction more explicit while preserving the actual normalization workflow reported in the first revision. The development and validation procedures themselves remain as previously reported: deterministic normalization for unambiguous lexical variants, similarity-based candidate generation for potentially equivalent expressions, manual validation before many-to-one

	thesaurus mapping, and iterative refinement as additional equivalent expressions were identified during descriptor and cluster inspection.
Quantitative evidence on descriptor preparation. Provide examples of thesaurus development and information on original descriptors, stopword removal, normalization/merging, and ambiguous terms requiring manual decisions so that the effect of terminology decisions can be assessed.	Descriptor preparation and normalization were substantially expanded during the first revision. Section 3.3 already describes the construction of the unified descriptor field from author keywords, index keywords, and noun phrases extracted from titles and abstracts; the multi-stage natural-language-processing procedure used for descriptor extraction; deterministic normalization of lexical variants; similarity- and stem-based identification of candidate equivalences; manual semantic validation; treatment of acronyms and conceptual synonyms; iterative thesaurus refinement; and removal of non-discriminative expressions. We agree that quantitative context regarding the overall effect of descriptor preparation can further improve transparency. Section 3.3 has therefore been revised to report that descriptor construction initially generated 47,795 distinct raw concepts and that the complete cleaning and normalization workflow resulted in an analytical vocabulary of 35,493 normalized concepts. We have also clarified that descriptor preparation constitutes a conceptual measurement stage rather than merely a lexical cleaning operation, because the resulting normalized descriptors are the analytical units on which emergence and co-occurrence are subsequently calculated. An important methodological distinction is necessary, however, regarding the requested information on terminology transformations. The procedure implemented in this study differs substantially from conventional bibliometric preprocessing based primarily on keyword cleaning, stopword lists, and thesaurus or replacement tables prepared before bibliometric mapping. In a simple replacement-table workflow, individual transformations can reasonably be represented as original term → replacement term and subsequently counted by transformation type. The present procedure is instead an integrated and iterative text-mining and conceptual-normalization workflow in which the controlled thesaurus is only one component of the overall process. Specifically, the descriptor space is constructed from three complementary sources—author keywords, index keywords, and noun phrases computationally extracted from titles and abstracts. Its subsequent normalization combines deterministic lexical transformations, computational identification of candidate relationships through similarity-based procedures, semantic assessment of candidate equivalences, acronym and synonym resolution, many-to-one conceptual mappings, removal of non-discriminative expressions, and iterative refinement informed by subsequent descriptor and cluster inspection. Computational similarity is therefore used to discover potential relationships at scale rather than to determine semantic equivalence automatically; candidate mappings requiring semantic judgment are consolidated only after conceptual validation. Consequently, the controlled thesaurus should not be interpreted as a complete transformation log, nor does the normalization process generate a set of mutually exclusive one-to-one terminology decisions. A raw expression may undergo several sequential or interacting operations before its final conceptual representation is established. The requested decomposition into separate counts of stopword removals, normalization/merging operations, and ambiguous manual decisions would therefore impose a retrospective replacement-table structure on a process that was neither designed nor executed in that manner. Such a decomposition could give a misleading representation of the actual descriptor-preparation procedure rather than improve its transparency. For this reason, the manuscript reports the information that can be interpreted directly and reproducibly for the implemented workflow: the sources from which descriptors were constructed, the principal computational and semantic normalization stages, the distinction between automated candidate identification and conceptual validation, representative examples of consolidation, the iterative role of the controlled thesaurus, and the size of the descriptor space before and after the complete workflow. A complete specification and evaluation of the underlying text-mining architecture—including its individual algorithms, candidate-generation mechanisms, semantic-validation procedures, and their interactions—would constitute a methodological study in its own right and falls beyond the scope of the present Food Analytics investigation.

Operational definition of emergence indicators. Clarify the operational definitions of novelty, growth, and emergence and strengthen the explanation of Porter's emergence indicators.	The operational specification of emergence was substantially addressed during the first revision. Section 3.5.1 already reports the temporal windows, novelty threshold, minimum total frequency, minimum number of active annual periods, recent-to-baseline growth-ratio threshold, and the sensitivity analysis used to select the growth-ratio cutoff. The first-round response also clarified that the study adopts the technical-emergence methodology of Porter et al. (2019) rather than proposing a new emergence indicator, and that only the growth-ratio threshold was empirically varied. Following the present comment, we recognized that the manuscript could distinguish more explicitly between the conceptual meaning of the emergence criteria and their operational implementation. Section 3.5.1 has therefore been clarified accordingly. In the revised text, novelty refers to comparatively limited descriptor activity in the baseline period relative to recent activity; growth refers to the increase in activity between the baseline and recent periods; persistence requires activity across multiple annual periods rather than a single isolated occurrence; and emergence refers to the joint satisfaction of these temporal conditions together with a minimum level of overall activity. The revised section also links each reported parameter to its analytical role. The novelty threshold constrains prior activity, activity in at least three annual periods implements the persistence requirement, the minimum total frequency excludes weak signals with insufficient empirical support, and the recent-to-baseline ratio imposes the growth requirement. This makes explicit how the Porter framework was operationalized in the present study while retaining the original methodological source for the formal derivation of the indicator. We have not reproduced Porter et al.'s indicator equations because these are not newly developed in the present study and were already addressed in the first-round response. Instead, the revision strengthens the interpretation of the adopted criteria and makes their operational roles transparent in the specific Food Analytics application.
Threshold selection. Provide a stronger rationale for the thresholds selected for Porter's emergence analysis and explain the associated decision process.	The threshold-selection procedure is already reported explicitly in the revised Section 3.5.1. The section now distinguishes the conceptual and operational roles of the parameters used in the Porter et al. (2019) framework. Novelty is defined in relation to comparatively limited baseline activity, growth as the increase in activity between the baseline and recent periods, and persistence as activity across multiple annual periods rather than an isolated occurrence. The manuscript also explains operationally that the novelty threshold constrains prior activity, the minimum number of active annual periods implements the persistence requirement, the minimum total frequency excludes signals with insufficient empirical support, and the recent-to-baseline ratio imposes the growth requirement. The complete parameterization is also reported: a three-year baseline period, a four-year recent period, a novelty threshold of 0.30, a minimum total frequency of seven records, activity in at least three annual periods, and a recent-to-baseline growth-ratio threshold of 1.12. Importantly, these parameters did not all result from an empirical optimization exercise. The growth-ratio threshold was the parameter subjected to sensitivity analysis because it directly controls the strength of recent growth required for a descriptor to qualify as emergent. It was evaluated from 1.00 to 1.20 in increments of 0.01, and 1.12 was retained because it provided the best balance between interpretability and consistency of the resulting thematic clusters. The remaining parameters formed part of the fixed operational configuration used to implement the emergence criteria and were not retrospectively optimized. We have re-examined Section 3.5.1 in response to this comment and consider that the revised text already makes both the operational role of the thresholds and the associated decision process explicit. Adding further numerical justification would imply an optimization or calibration procedure that was not performed and would therefore misrepresent the actual analysis.
Threshold sensitivity and robustness. Provide quantitative evidence of how alternative thresholds affect the number of emergent descriptors, cluster stability, and thematic interpretation, and consider additional robustness analysis.	The sensitivity procedure actually implemented in the study is already reported in Section 3.5.1. The recent-to-baseline growth-ratio threshold was examined from 1.00 to 1.20 in increments of 0.01, and 1.12 was retained because it provided the best balance between interpretability and consistency of the resulting thematic clusters. The remaining parameters formed part of the fixed

	operational configuration of the Porter et al. (2019) emergence procedure and were not subjected to a multidimensional optimization exercise. An important methodological distinction is necessary regarding the additional robustness analysis proposed in this comment. The present study is not a conventional keyword-based bibliometric mapping exercise in which author keywords are filtered by a frequency threshold, directly transformed into a co-occurrence network, and then clustered. The analytical units used here are normalized descriptors constructed through an upstream text-mining process integrating author keywords, index keywords, and noun phrases extracted from titles and abstracts, followed by conceptual normalization and thesaurus-based consolidation. Porter's emergence criteria are subsequently applied to this normalized descriptor space to identify concepts exhibiting the required temporal behavior. The emergence-detection and community-detection stages are therefore analytically distinct. Porter et al.'s (2019) emergence methodology identifies emerging topics from their temporal patterns; cluster stability is not part of the definition or validation of the emergence indicator. In the present study, Louvain community detection constitutes a subsequent analytical stage introduced to examine how the descriptors already identified as emergent are relationally organized. The growth-ratio threshold is consequently a parameter of emergence detection, not a clustering hyperparameter, and the Louvain solution is not an objective function through which that threshold is estimated or validated. This distinction also explains why the implemented sensitivity procedure did not generate a matrix of alternative clustering solutions, partition-stability coefficients, or thematic interpretations for every threshold. Such outputs are not intrinsic products of the Porter emergence procedure. Reconstructing them retrospectively would introduce a new post hoc robustness experiment in which a downstream analytical technique—community detection—is used to validate an upstream emergence criterion. We carefully considered the reviewer's request to add such an analysis. However, doing so would change the methodological logic of the study rather than improve the reporting of the analysis actually conducted. It would also risk conflating two separate questions: which descriptors exhibit emergence according to their temporal behavior, and how the descriptors identified as emergent are subsequently organized into a relational thematic structure. For these reasons, we have retained the sensitivity analysis as implemented and transparently reported in Section 3.5.1 rather than introducing a retrospective clustering-robustness framework. The manuscript reports the parameter varied, the complete range examined, the increment, the selected value, and the decision criterion. The subsequent co-word and Louvain analyses serve a different purpose: to reveal the thematic organization of the emerging descriptor set after emergence has been established.
Five Louvain clusters to four dimensions. Explain more explicitly the interpretive process and rationale for transforming five empirical Louvain clusters into four higher-order conceptual dimensions.	We clarify that the five Louvain communities and the four higher-order dimensions correspond to different analytical levels. The five communities constitute the empirical network-partitioning result and remain unchanged in the analysis; the four dimensions result from the subsequent conceptual interpretation of that structure. Thus, the study does not quantitatively transform a five-cluster solution into a four-cluster solution. This distinction is particularly important in bibliometric clustering and thematic interpretation. Algorithmically distinct communities are not necessarily conceptually independent themes. A source of thematic redundancy can occur when the clustering structure separates methodological or technological descriptors from descriptors representing substantive problems or application domains. Such communities can be structurally distinguishable because their vocabularies and co-occurrence relationships differ while still representing complementary components of the same research theme. Interpreting each community as an independent higher-order theme can consequently produce repetitive or overlapping thematic accounts. For this reason, the interpretive stage examined the substantive relationships among the descriptors and associated publications to determine whether structurally distinct communities represented independent themes or complementary perspectives on the same underlying research problems. This is a conceptual interpretation task rather than a decision that can be determined

	solely from community size, centrality, density, or other network metrics. Such measures characterize the structural properties of communities but do not establish their conceptual independence. In the present study, the five Louvain communities are therefore retained and reported as the quantitative community-detection result. Their subsequent interpretation showed that four communities corresponded predominantly to substantive research trajectories, whereas the fifth was primarily methodological and contained analytical approaches that operated across those substantive themes. The four dimensions were therefore developed as a higher-order conceptual synthesis that preserves the substantive structure of the empirical solution while integrating cross-cutting methodological elements into the dimensions in which they are applied. The manuscript has been clarified accordingly so that the four-dimensional framework is explicitly presented as an interpretive synthesis of the five empirical communities rather than as an alternative clustering solution.
Search protocol and retrieval bias. Clarify the final search protocol, decision rules, and potential retrieval bias in the main text.	The final search protocol and its decision rules were substantially expanded during the first revision. The main text now describes the iterative and evidence-driven development of the search strategy, while Tables 3 and 4 document its conceptual organization, principal refinement decisions, retrieval effects, rationale, and stopping criterion. Supplementary File S1 complements this information by providing the complete executable retrieval protocol. Specifically, Supplementary File S1 reports the database, search fields, search date, temporal coverage, absence of document-type and language restrictions at the retrieval stage, consolidation and deduplication procedure, and the seven complete Scopus queries exactly as executed. It also states the distinct retrieval function assigned to each strategy. STRICT served as a high-precision benchmark based on explicit Food Analytics terminology; MAIN-1 to MAIN-3 provided alternative primary operationalizations intended to increase robustness across terminology and indexing practices; and COMPLEMENTARY-1 to COMPLEMENTARY-3 targeted adjacent application and methodological vocabularies capable of representing Food Analytics research without necessarily using the field's core terminology. This architecture is directly relevant to the reviewer’s concern regarding retrieval bias. Food Analytics is an interdisciplinary and terminologically heterogeneous research domain, and reliance on a single field label or query would create substantial terminology-dependent retrieval risk. The use of multiple independently executed but complementary search strategies was therefore a deliberate mechanism for reducing dependence on any single terminology or indexing formulation. The iterative refinement process further evaluated candidate formulations according to conceptual coverage, retrieval precision, off-domain retrieval, and substantive relevance. Nevertheless, we agree that the residual limitation of this strategy can be stated more explicitly in the main text. No Boolean search architecture can completely eliminate terminology-dependent retrieval bias. Relevant publications expressed exclusively through terminology not represented in the final queries may remain outside the corpus, while broader formulations may retrieve adjacent applications requiring subsequent eligibility assessment. We have therefore clarified this residual retrieval-bias consideration in the main text. We have not duplicated the complete search protocol in the main manuscript because it is already reported reproducibly in Supplementary File S1, while the main text reports the methodological logic, development process, decision rules, and screening procedure. The additional revision is consequently limited to making the potential residual retrieval bias more explicit.
Reproducible search documentation. Provide complete executable Scopus search strings, database fields, search dates, and retrieval settings in a supplementary methodological appendix.	This information is already provided in full in Supplementary File S1, which was prepared specifically to ensure reproducibility of the corpus-construction procedure. The supplementary file reports the database used, the search date, temporal coverage, document-type and language settings at the retrieval stage, the fields searched, the procedure used to combine and deduplicate the retrieved records, and the complete executable Scopus search strings for all seven strategies. Specifically, Supplementary File S1 reproduces verbatim the queries labeled STRICT, MAIN-1, MAIN-2, MAIN-3, COMPLEMENTARY-1, COMPLEMENTARY-2, and COMPLEMENTARY-3, including field

	specifications, Boolean operators, proximity operators, parentheses, phrase marks, and wildcards. The file also states that the searches were executed in Scopus on May 2, 2026, with coverage of all years available up to that date and without document-type or language restrictions at the search stage. Because the requested reproducibility information is already contained in the supplementary methodological documentation in executable form, no further modification was made in response to this comment.
Terminological variation and corpus construction. Discuss how terminology variation—e.g., *food analytics*, *food informatics*, *food intelligence*, and *smart food systems*—may influence corpus construction.	Terminological variation was already explicitly considered in the construction of the search strategy. Rather than relying on "Food Analytics" as a single field label, the search began with ten high-specificity expressions and was progressively expanded through examination of titles, abstracts, author keywords, index keywords, and cited-reference titles. The final complementary-query architecture was specifically designed to reduce dependence on any single label or vocabulary, while the manuscript already acknowledges that retrieval remains terminology-dependent and that relevant studies expressed exclusively through terms absent from the final queries may have been omitted. In response to this comment, Section 3.1.2 has been further clarified to explain how such variation affects corpus construction. The revised text emphasizes that labels such as food informatics, food intelligence, and smart food systems may overlap with Food Analytics without being conceptually equivalent to it. Consequently, incorporating adjacent terminology can improve coverage but can also increase off-domain retrieval. This trade-off was addressed through repeated execution and empirical inspection of candidate query formulations, followed by eligibility screening against the operational scope of Food Analytics. The clarification therefore makes explicit that corpus construction was not based on treating alternative field labels as synonyms. Instead, terminology was used as a retrieval mechanism, while substantive alignment with the operational definition of Food Analytics determined eligibility for the final analytical corpus.
Single-researcher screening and selection bias. Explicitly acknowledge screening by a single researcher with computational support as a potential source of selection bias.	The manuscript already reported that eligibility screening was conducted by a single researcher with computational support and that final inclusion and exclusion decisions remained under researcher control. In response to this comment, we have made the potential limitation of this procedure more explicit in Section 6. The revised text now acknowledges that, despite computational support and predefined eligibility criteria, reliance on a single researcher rather than independent screening by multiple reviewers may introduce selection bias through researcher judgment, particularly in borderline cases. This clarification explicitly recognizes the potential source of bias while accurately reflecting the screening procedure used in the study.
Screening quality control. Consider independent validation, sensitivity checking, or expert assessment of borderline records; if additional reviewers are not used, explain the quality-control mechanisms employed to minimize subjective decisions.	Independent multiple-reviewer screening, expert assessment, or sensitivity checking of borderline records was not part of the study design. We have therefore clarified the quality-control mechanisms actually employed rather than introducing retrospective validation procedures. Screening was conducted in two stages using the operational definition of Food Analytics and predefined eligibility criteria. Computational and metadata-based procedures first identified candidate exclusions, which were subsequently validated by the researcher; titles and abstracts were then assessed separately against the same predefined eligibility framework, with final eligibility decisions remaining under researcher control. In response to the reviewer's comment, the Data Collection and Preliminary Preparation section now explicitly identifies these procedures as screening quality-control mechanisms. Specifically, quality control relied on the consistent application of predefined criteria across records, computational identification of candidate exclusions followed by researcher validation, and a separate title-and-abstract assessment against the operational definition of Food Analytics. These procedures provided a structured decision process intended to minimize subjective variation. As separately acknowledged in the Limitations section, the absence of independent multiple-reviewer screening nevertheless remains a potential source of selection bias, particularly in borderline cases.

Bibliometric reporting standards. Consider alignment with BIBLIO (Montazeri et al., 2023), particularly regarding search transparency, analytical procedures, and reproducibility.	BIBLIO (Montazeri et al., 2023) was already evaluated in detail during the first revision, including an item-by-item assessment of its reporting recommendations. The applicable recommendations were incorporated where they strengthened transparency and reproducibility. Accordingly, the revised manuscript already reports the database-selection rationale and associated tradeoffs (Section 3.1.1); the iterative search-development procedure, complete executable search strategies, retrieval conditions, and stopping criteria (Section 3.1.2, Tables 3–4, and Supplementary File S1); explicit eligibility and screening procedures and reconciled corpus-flow counts (Section 3.2 and Figure 1); descriptor extraction, cleaning, and normalization procedures (Section 3.3); emergence parameters and sensitivity analysis (Section 3.5.1); network and clustering specifications (Section 3.5.2); and the procedure used to interpret the resulting thematic structure (Section 3.5.3). As explained in our first-round response, however, BIBLIO was not adopted as the governing methodological or reporting framework because the present study is a technological-intelligence investigation implemented through bibliometric tech-mining methods rather than a conventional bibliometric literature review. BIBLIO was therefore considered selectively where its recommendations were applicable to the present research design, while PRISMA-S and PRISMA 2020 conventions were used specifically to strengthen search-strategy and study-flow reporting. We have rechecked these elements in the present revision and consider the concerns regarding search transparency, analytical procedures, and reproducibility to be already addressed.
Quantitative support for the thematic framework. Strengthen the empirical evidence supporting the transition from five clusters to four dimensions, considering relevant cluster characteristics, network properties, descriptor relationships, temporal patterns, or other appropriate quantitative evidence.	We clarify that the five Louvain communities and the four higher-order dimensions correspond to different analytical levels. The five communities constitute the empirical network-partitioning result and remain unchanged in the analysis; the four dimensions result from the subsequent conceptual interpretation of that structure. Thus, the study does not quantitatively transform a five-cluster solution into a four-cluster solution. This distinction is particularly important in bibliometric clustering and thematic interpretation. Algorithmically distinct communities are not necessarily conceptually independent themes. A source of thematic redundancy can occur when the clustering structure separates methodological or technological descriptors from descriptors representing substantive problems or application domains. Such communities can be structurally distinguishable because their vocabularies and co-occurrence relationships differ while still representing complementary components of the same research theme. Interpreting each community as an independent higher-order theme can consequently produce repetitive or overlapping thematic accounts. For this reason, the interpretation of bibliometric clusters necessarily involves examining the substantive relationships among their descriptors and associated publications and determining whether structurally distinct communities represent independent themes or complementary perspectives on the same underlying research problem. This is a conceptual interpretation task rather than a decision that can be determined from community size, centrality, density, or other network metrics. Such measures are useful for characterizing the structural properties of communities, but they do not establish their conceptual independence. In the present study, the five Louvain communities are therefore retained and reported as the quantitative community-detection result. Their subsequent interpretation showed that four communities corresponded predominantly to substantive research trajectories, whereas the fifth was primarily methodological and contained analytical approaches that operated across those substantive themes. The four dimensions were therefore developed as a higher-order conceptual synthesis that preserves the substantive structure of the empirical solution while integrating cross-cutting methodological elements into the dimensions in which they are applied. Community size and representative descriptors are reported to characterize the empirical five-community solution, but these structural characteristics do not constitute a numerical rule for determining conceptual independence. Introducing such a numerical criterion to determine the four-dimensional synthesis would conflate community detection with thematic interpretation and would add a post hoc analytical procedure that was not part of the study design.

	We have clarified this distinction in the manuscript so that the four-dimensional framework is explicitly presented as an interpretive synthesis of the five empirical communities, rather than as an alternative clustering solution.
Interpretation of the emerging dimensions. Move beyond technological description to explain the theoretical meaning of the four dimensions and how they characterize the evolution of Food Analytics as a socio-technical research field.	The individual dimension sections already describe the substantive technologies, applications, methodological developments, and limitations associated with each emerging dimension. We agree, however, that their collective theoretical meaning for the development of Food Analytics as a research field could be made more explicit. We have therefore added a higher-level conceptual interpretation immediately following the presentation of the five-cluster solution and its four-dimensional synthesis. The revised text interprets intelligent food quality and composition analytics as an evidence-generating function; predictive and operational food-system analytics as extending this evidence toward system-level forecasting, coordination, optimization, and decision support; personalized nutrition and consumer analytics as introducing a human-centered analytical function; and semantic, generative, and knowledge-driven food analytics as providing a knowledge-integration function through which heterogeneous evidence can be represented, connected, interpreted, and reused. Considered together, these dimensions characterize Food Analytics not merely through the emergence of new technologies, but through the increasing integration of food-system evidence, analytical intelligence, decision processes, human contexts, and knowledge infrastructures. The revised interpretation therefore positions the four dimensions as complementary functions within an emerging socio-technical research field rather than as a taxonomy of technologies. Importantly, we do not interpret these dimensions as a deterministic chronological sequence. The emergence analysis supports their contemporary development and interaction, whereas establishing a fixed progression from one dimension to another would go beyond the evidence provided by the study.
Possible evolutionary trajectory of the field. Discuss whether the evidence supports a progression from measurement-oriented analytics toward predictive intelligence, personalized decision systems, and knowledge-generating AI architectures.	The evidence is consistent with a directional interpretation of the development of Food Analytics, but not with a deterministic sequence of discrete stages. The four dimensions collectively suggest an expansion in analytical scope from measurement and characterization of food properties toward predictive and operational intelligence, increasingly personalized decision systems, and, more recently, semantic and generative architectures capable of integrating and producing food-related knowledge. We have strengthened the opening synthesis in Section 5 to make this interpretation explicit. Importantly, the revised manuscript does not present the four dimensions as a chronological stage model in which one paradigm replaces another. The dimensions coexist, overlap, and increasingly interact. Measurement-oriented analytics continues to support predictive systems; predictive capabilities contribute to personalized applications; and semantic and generative architectures increasingly integrate evidence originating across the other dimensions. The manuscript therefore interprets the observed trajectory as cumulative and integrative rather than sequential. In this sense, the evolution of Food Analytics is characterized less by replacement of earlier analytical approaches than by the progressive recombination of measurement, prediction, personalization, and knowledge-generation capabilities within a more interconnected analytical field.
Critical Discussion. Strengthen the Discussion by explaining why particular themes emerged and by addressing contradictions, unresolved tensions, assumptions, limitations, and practical feasibility rather than predominantly describing technological possibilities.	The dimension-specific discussion already identifies important limitations associated with the emerging themes, including dataset representativeness and transferability, interoperability and infrastructure constraints, model generalizability and explainability, privacy and cultural variability, semantic misalignment, reliability, bias, and regulatory compliance. We agree, however, that these issues were discussed primarily within individual dimensions and that their broader implications for the development of Food Analytics required a more explicit critical synthesis. We have therefore strengthened Section 5 by explaining both why these themes are emerging and the tensions created by their convergence. The revised

	discussion relates their emergence to the increasing availability and heterogeneity of food-system data together with advances in sensing, computational modeling, connected infrastructures, and AI. At the same time, it emphasizes that increasing analytical sophistication can create greater dependence on data quality, interoperability, computational infrastructure, and representative datasets; that personalization creates tensions involving privacy, transparency, and equity; and that semantic and generative systems introduce additional concerns regarding reliability, bias, explainability, and governance. The revised discussion also explicitly distinguishes technological emergence from practical maturity. An emerging analytical capability does not by itself demonstrate transferability, organizational feasibility, sustained impact, or responsible implementation. Accordingly, the manuscript now argues that the development of Food Analytics depends not only on further improvements in analytical performance, but also on validation across heterogeneous settings, integration with organizational decision processes, data governance, interoperability, and responsible-AI conditions. These revisions shift the concluding interpretation from a predominantly technology-centered account toward a more critical assessment of the assumptions, trade-offs, implementation constraints, and unresolved tensions associated with the emerging research frontier.
Food Analytics as an interdisciplinary field. Explain whether and how the four dimensions conceptualize Food Analytics as a convergence of food science, information systems, artificial intelligence, consumer analytics, and decision sciences rather than merely an application domain of AI.	The four-dimensional framework already characterizes Food Analytics through complementary evidence-generating, system-level decision, human-centered, and knowledge-integration functions. We agree, however, that the disciplinary convergence underlying these functions could be stated more explicitly. We have therefore extended the conceptual synthesis following Table 5 to clarify that the four dimensions reflect the convergence of food science, information systems, artificial intelligence, consumer analytics, and decision sciences. These disciplinary perspectives contribute different but interdependent forms of domain knowledge, analytical capability, information infrastructure, behavioral understanding, and decision support to the developing structure of Food Analytics. Importantly, the revision also clarifies the role of AI within this framework. AI and machine learning are present across multiple dimensions and function as transversal analytical capabilities, but they do not by themselves define the field. Food Analytics is instead conceptualized as a socio-technical research field emerging from the integration of food-domain knowledge, analytical intelligence, information and knowledge infrastructures, human contexts, and decision processes. This distinction positions Food Analytics as an interdisciplinary convergence rather than merely an application domain of AI.
Interactions among dimensions. Explain how the emerging themes/dimensions interact and what these interactions indicate about the evolution of Food Analytics.	The manuscript already identified several cross-dimensional relationships, particularly the role of semantic and knowledge-driven approaches in connecting information on food composition, processing, supply chains, nutrition, and consumption. We agree, however, that the implications of these interactions for the development of Food Analytics could be stated more explicitly. We have therefore strengthened the cross-dimensional synthesis in Section 5 to clarify that the four dimensions are functionally interdependent rather than isolated thematic domains. Evidence generated through food quality and composition analytics can support predictive, operational, and personalized applications; consumer and operational data provide additional context for analytical decision-making; and semantic and generative architectures can connect, interpret, and reuse knowledge produced across these activities. The revised discussion interprets these interactions as evidence of increasing integration within Food Analytics. Rather than developing solely through separate technological or application streams, the field is increasingly characterized by connections among evidence generation, prediction, operational and individualized decision support, and knowledge integration. This suggests an evolution from relatively specialized analytical applications toward a more interconnected analytical ecosystem in which the capabilities represented by the four dimensions increasingly complement and reinforce one another. We have deliberately framed these relationships as an interpretive synthesis rather than as demonstrated causal flows between dimensions, because the

	bibliometric evidence supports thematic interdependence but does not establish directional causal relationships among research streams.
Stakeholder and practical implications. Link the empirical frontier more explicitly to food industries, technology developers, researchers, policymakers, and regulatory institutions, including implications for decision-making, operational efficiency, food safety management, sustainable food systems, and personalized nutrition.	The dimension-specific discussion already identifies practical applications involving food quality and safety assessment, predictive and operational decision support, supply-chain coordination, personalized nutrition, and semantic and generative knowledge systems. We agree, however, that these implications were distributed across the four dimensions and that their relevance to specific stakeholder groups could be made more explicit. We have therefore strengthened the stakeholder-oriented synthesis in Section 5 to link the empirical frontier directly to food industries, technology developers, researchers, policymakers, and regulatory institutions. For food industries, the identified convergence of quality, operational, and predictive analytics supports integrated decision-making in quality assurance, food safety management, forecasting, traceability, resource allocation, and waste reduction. For technology developers, the frontier emphasizes the need for interoperable, explainable, reliable, and transferable analytical systems capable of integrating heterogeneous food-system data. For researchers, the interactions among the four dimensions identify opportunities for integrating compositional, operational, consumer, and knowledge-based evidence and for developing infrastructures that support analytical knowledge reuse across applications. The revised discussion also makes the implications for policymakers and regulatory institutions explicit, particularly regarding data quality, interoperability, model validation, transparency, privacy, and accountability as analytical outputs increasingly influence food-safety and health-related decisions. Finally, the revision connects the frontier to sustainable food systems through resource efficiency, traceability, waste reduction, and operational coordination, and to personalized nutrition through individualized decision support while recognizing associated privacy, equity, and reliability requirements. These additions link the practical implications directly to the empirical dimensions identified in the study rather than presenting generic recommendations about the adoption of AI in food systems.
Implementation barriers and responsible AI. Strengthen discussion of data interoperability, data governance, algorithmic transparency, privacy, digital inequality, regulatory concerns, technology-adoption barriers, and responsible AI deployment.	The discussion has been strengthened to address the implementation and responsible-AI issues identified by the reviewer. Section 5 now explicitly distinguishes technological emergence from operational maturity and discusses the conditions that may constrain the translation of emerging Food Analytics capabilities into practice. Specifically, the revised discussion addresses data interoperability and representative data infrastructures; effective data governance; algorithmic transparency and explainability; privacy protection; regulatory uncertainty; organizational and technological capabilities; and unequal access to digital infrastructure. The latter is also considered from a societal perspective, where differences in infrastructure, data availability, technological capabilities, and affordability are identified as potential sources of digital inequality. Responsible AI deployment is now explicitly framed as requiring attention not only to model performance but also to transparency, accountability, privacy, fairness, human oversight, and the technical, organizational, and institutional conditions under which analytical systems are adopted and integrated into decision processes. These barriers are subsequently connected to the research agenda through priorities involving FAIR-compliant and interoperable data infrastructures, robust and transferable models, explainable and knowledge-informed architectures, and participatory governance involving researchers, industry, regulators, practitioners, and consumers. These revisions provide a more critical account of the conditions under which the emerging Food Analytics frontier can move from technological capability toward responsible and practically feasible implementation.
Specific future research directions. Derive concrete future research directions from the detected emerging themes rather than providing only general recommendations.	The manuscript already identified four future research priorities involving interoperable data infrastructures, robust and transferable models, multimodal and hybrid knowledge architectures, and participatory governance. We agree, however, that their derivation from the empirically detected emerging dimensions could be made more explicit.

	We have therefore revised the final paragraph of Section 5 so that each research direction is now directly linked to the emerging structure identified in the study. The convergence of intelligent food quality and composition analytics with predictive and operational applications motivates research on interoperable infrastructures connecting spectral, compositional, process, and supply-chain data. The expansion of predictive, operational, and personalized analytics motivates validation of explainable and transferable models across products, populations, regions, and real-world settings. The emergence of semantic, generative, and knowledge-driven analytics motivates multimodal and hybrid architectures connecting compositional, operational, nutritional, and consumer evidence. Finally, increasing interaction among all four dimensions motivates research on governance and implementation models addressing data governance, algorithmic transparency, privacy, human oversight, and stakeholder participation. The revised research agenda is therefore derived explicitly from the detected emerging dimensions and their interactions rather than presented as a set of general recommendations for Food Analytics.
Theory–practice contribution. Explain more explicitly how the findings advance knowledge and bridge technological innovation with practical application in food systems.	The revised manuscript already strengthens both sides of the theory–practice contribution. Conceptually, the four dimensions position Food Analytics as an interdisciplinary socio-technical field arising from the convergence of food science, information systems, artificial intelligence, consumer analytics, and decision sciences rather than merely as an application domain of AI. Practically, the discussion identifies implications for food-industry decision-making, food safety and quality management, supply-chain operations, personalized nutrition, technology development, and policy and regulatory activities. To make the connection between these contributions more explicit, we have extended the conceptual synthesis in Section 5. The revised text explains how the four emerging dimensions provide a bridge between technological innovation and practical application: advances in sensing and analytical modeling, predictive intelligence, consumer-oriented analytics, and semantic and generative technologies translate into capabilities for measuring food properties, coordinating food-system processes, supporting individualized decisions, and integrating knowledge for decision support. The manuscript therefore advances knowledge not simply by identifying emerging technologies, but by explaining how their convergence expands the analytical capabilities through which heterogeneous food-system data can be transformed into evidence, predictions, decisions, and reusable knowledge. This explicitly connects the conceptual interpretation of the emerging Food Analytics frontier with the practical functions that these developments can support across food systems.
Conclusions. Connect the conclusions more explicitly to the research gap, methodological contribution, empirical findings, and theoretical implications established in the manuscript.	The Conclusions have been revised to connect the study's final claims more explicitly to the research gap, methodological contribution, empirical findings, and theoretical implications developed throughout the manuscript. The revised conclusion first returns to the research gap by distinguishing the study from previous accounts that have examined individual technologies and applications without identifying how recent developments combine to form the emerging Food Analytics frontier. It then states the methodological contribution explicitly: descriptor enrichment and normalization are integrated with descriptor-level emergence detection before co-word network construction and community detection, allowing the thematic analysis to focus specifically on emergent rather than established research topics. The empirical contribution is summarized through the 111 emergent descriptors, five Louvain communities, and four higher-order analytical dimensions. The theoretical implication is then made explicit by interpreting these dimensions as evidence that Food Analytics is developing not merely as an application domain of AI, but as an interdisciplinary socio-technical field in which food-science knowledge, information infrastructures, analytical intelligence, consumer contexts, and decision processes increasingly converge. Finally, the conclusion connects this emerging structure to practical implementation while retaining the methodological caution that emergence indicates novelty, persistence, and recent growth in the literature rather than demonstrated technological impact, effectiveness, or future importance.

Accessibility of methodological communication. Reduce unnecessary methodological jargon and define technical concepts more clearly for BFJ readers outside bibliometric and computational research.	We reviewed the methodological sections specifically in relation to this comment. We consider that the current manuscript already provides the level of methodological explanation appropriate for the intended BFJ readership while retaining the terminology necessary for analytical precision and reproducibility. Specialized concepts are introduced together with their analytical meaning and role in the study. In particular, the manuscript explains the construction and normalization of descriptors, the temporal meaning of emergence through novelty, growth, and persistence, the construction of the co-word network, the role of Louvain community detection, and the subsequent interpretation of empirical communities as higher-order dimensions. We have therefore retained the current methodological terminology and level of detail. Further simplification would require either replacing established methodological terms with less precise language or adding elementary explanations of standard analytical concepts, neither of which would improve the methodological communication of the study. This decision also preserves the methodological transparency and reproducibility requested elsewhere in the review. No additional manuscript modification was made in response to this comment.
Acronyms and terminology. Ensure consistent definition and use of acronyms and specialized terminology throughout the manuscript.	Acronyms and specialized terminology had already been reviewed for consistency during the first revision. In response to this second-round comment, we conducted an additional manuscript-wide audit to verify that acronyms are defined at first use and subsequently used consistently, and that specialized methodological terminology is applied uniformly throughout the manuscript. Particular attention was given to terms associated with technological intelligence, bibliometric tech mining, descriptor construction and normalization, emergence analysis, co-word analysis, and community detection. Terminology was standardized where necessary to avoid ambiguity and maintain conceptual consistency across the Methods, Results, and Discussion sections.
Language and readability. Conduct careful language editing, particularly in the Methods and Discussion, to improve clarity and readability.	As reported in our response to the first review, the manuscript had already undergone a comprehensive language and readability audit. Following the present recommendation, we conducted an additional focused review, particularly of the Methods and Discussion sections. Sentence structure, clarity, readability, terminology, and academic style were re-examined, and dense passages were revised where this could improve accessibility without sacrificing methodological precision.
Recommended additional references. Evaluate the eight references recommended by the reviewer and incorporate those that substantively strengthen methodological positioning, bibliometric justification, or contextual discussion.	Thank you for providing these additional references and, particularly, for specifying the intended rationale for each suggested citation. We carefully examined all eight references in relation to the specific methodological, conceptual, or contextual role proposed in the review. Following this assessment, we concluded that seven of the eight references would not substantively strengthen the manuscript, while Montazeri et al. (2023) had already been examined during the first revision for its relevant contribution to bibliometric reporting transparency. Regarding Azizan (2025), the reviewer suggests this study as a methodological comparison for bibliometric network analysis and knowledge-structure mapping. We carefully examined this possibility. The study represents a conventional bibliometric network-analysis design based on bibliographic records, publication indicators, author keywords, co-occurrence relationships, and knowledge-structure mapping. The present investigation addresses a substantially different analytical problem. It does not use database-supplied keywords directly as the principal analytical representation of the literature. Instead, it computationally constructs an enriched descriptor space from author keywords, index keywords, and noun phrases extracted from titles and abstracts; normalizes these descriptors through a thesaurus-based procedure; evaluates emergence at the normalized-descriptor level; and only subsequently constructs the co-occurrence network of the descriptors identified as emergent. Thus, the network analyzed in the present study represents the structure of the emerging research frontier, rather than the general knowledge structure of the retrieved literature. For this reason, Azizan (2025) does not provide a methodological precedent for the analytical architecture employed here, and its

	inclusion as methodological support could incorrectly suggest equivalence between substantially different analytical designs. Regarding Rahman et al. (2025), the reviewer indicates that this reference demonstrates rigorous validation approaches and methodological transparency relevant to research reliability. We agree that methodological transparency and reliability are essential; however, the validation procedures examined in that article concern the psychometric validation of a physical-activity questionnaire, including construct validity, convergent validity, test–retest reliability, and inter-rater reliability. These forms of validation address the measurement properties of a questionnaire administered to human participants. They are not validation procedures for bibliographic corpus construction, descriptor normalization, temporal emergence detection, co-occurrence networks, or community detection. Consequently, transferring this reference to the present methodological discussion would conflate fundamentally different forms of validity and reliability and would not provide appropriate support for the procedures employed in this study. Regarding Ong et al. (2025), the suggested rationale is methodological comparison regarding bibliometric mapping and research-trend identification. We also examined this reference in detail. Its approach relies on conventional bibliometric indicators and author-keyword analysis, together with bibliometric mapping and visualization. This differs fundamentally from the present study's identification of research emergence. In our analytical design, an emerging concept is not inferred simply because a keyword appears recently or becomes visible in a bibliometric map. Emergence is evaluated quantitatively at the level of normalized descriptors using temporal evidence before network construction. The resulting emergent descriptors subsequently constitute the analytical units of the co-word network and community analysis. Ong et al. therefore illustrates bibliometric trend mapping, but it does not provide methodological support for descriptor-level emergence detection or for constructing a thematic structure specifically from an empirically detected research frontier. Regarding Abdullah et al. (2024), the reviewer proposes this reference to support publication-trend analysis and thematic evolution. The study uses established bibliometric software and conventional procedures for database integration, publication trends, keyword co-occurrence, network visualization, and thematic identification. These procedures address a different analytical objective from the present investigation. Our purpose is not to describe publication trends or infer thematic evolution from changes in keyword occurrence. The study first constructs and normalizes a substantially richer conceptual representation of the corpus and then applies an explicit emergence-detection procedure before the network and clustering stages. Consequently, Abdullah et al. (2024) neither provides methodological support for this analytical sequence nor contributes substantively to the interpretation of the Food Analytics frontier identified here. Adding it merely as an example of publication-trend analysis would therefore not strengthen the argument of the manuscript. Regarding Adawiyah et al. (2023), the reviewer proposes the article as an interdisciplinary behavioral-analytics perspective relevant to the consumer-analytics discussion. We found the connection insufficiently direct for citation in the present manuscript. The article examines smartphone addiction, personality traits, and cyberloafing behavior among Malaysian youths using a cross-sectional questionnaire design and conventional statistical analysis. It does not investigate food consumers, food-related behavior, personalized nutrition, consumer decision support, or Food Analytics. Behavioral data analysis in a different substantive domain does not, by itself, establish conceptual relevance to the consumer-analytics dimension identified empirically in this study. Its inclusion would therefore broaden the meaning of consumer analytics beyond the empirical and conceptual boundaries established by the Food Analytics corpus. Regarding Azizan et al. (2026), the suggested justification concerns health-related analytics, screening systems, and evidence-synthesis approaches. The paper reviews community-based frailty and malnutrition screening in older adults. Although malnutrition is substantively related to nutrition and health, the study does not investigate analytics as conceptualized in the present research, nor does it examine AI-enabled food analytics, personalized analytical systems, consumer analytics, or computational decision-support architectures.

	The presence of nutritional screening is therefore not sufficient to establish a direct conceptual connection with the research frontier identified in our study. We consequently concluded that this reference would not strengthen the interpretation of the Food Analytics dimensions. Regarding Muawanah et al. (2026), the reviewer suggests that the study demonstrates evidence-based intervention research and can strengthen the discussion of translation from analytical evidence to practical outcomes. We agree with the general importance of translating research evidence into practice. However, the article is a quasi-experimental clinical/sports intervention study examining neuromuscular taping and therapeutic exercise in soccer players. It does not address analytics, food systems, bibliometric or technological-intelligence methods, or the translation of analytical technologies into organizational or policy decisions. Citing an unrelated intervention study merely because it illustrates translation from evidence to practice would not provide substantive support for the practical implications derived from the Food Analytics research frontier. Finally, regarding Montazeri et al. (2023), we agree that BIBLIO is relevant to transparency in bibliometric reporting. This reference had already been examined during the first revision. We nevertheless emphasize the distinction already made in our methodological clarification: BIBLIO provides minimum reporting recommendations for bibliometric reviews; it does not constitute a methodology for conducting the technological-intelligence analysis implemented in the present study. We therefore considered its recommendations selectively where they improve transparency and reproducibility without redefining the analytical design of the investigation. On this basis, we have not added the other seven suggested references. This decision was not based on their quality or value within their respective research domains, but on their substantive relevance to the claims they were proposed to support. The bibliometric references illustrate comparatively conventional approaches to publication trends, keyword analysis, bibliometric mapping, and knowledge-structure visualization, whereas the present study constructs and normalizes an enriched descriptor space, quantitatively detects emergence at the descriptor level, and subsequently analyzes the network structure of the resulting emerging frontier. The remaining suggested references concern psychometric validation, behavioral research, health screening, or therapeutic intervention and therefore do not provide transferable methodological or conceptual evidence for the present investigation. We believe that incorporating references whose methods or substantive objects do not support the claims made in this manuscript would reduce, rather than improve, the precision of its methodological and conceptual positioning.

Thank you once again for this opportunity to improve our manuscript. During the revision process, please let me know if you need any additional instructions or clarifications.

Sincerely,

The Authors.